*Asarum delavayi

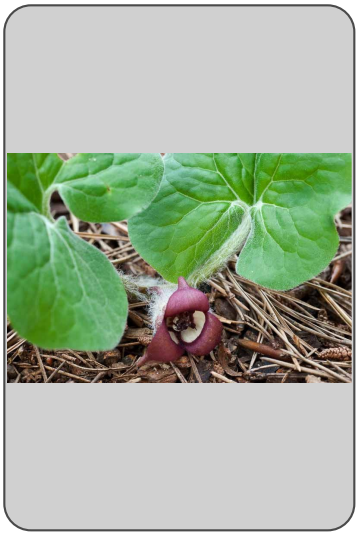
Chinese giant wild ginger, Delavay's wild ginger

Family: Aristolochiaceae

Passage N_S: 14 **TOTAL 14**



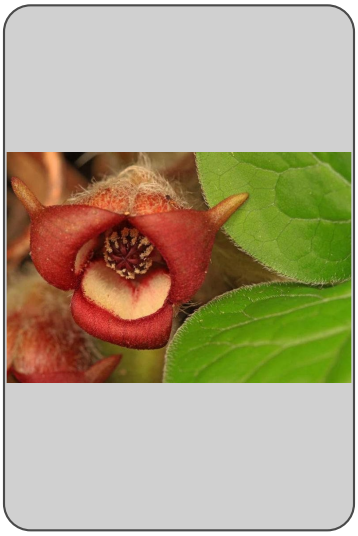
HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 6–8 in (15–20 cm) tall × 12–24 in (30–60 cm) wide. groundcover. Slowly forming stoloniferous clumps.
Leaves on petioles 10–21 cm

Sun

Water

Soil
Rich, humus-rich, average to well-drained. Prefers neutral to acid. Good drainage essential. Forest floor type soils

Zone 8a
Hardy Zones 7b–10b. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a in shade with consistent moisture and good drainage. Evergreen groundcover potential. Heat and humidity tolerant in shade

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to SW Sichuan and NE Yunnan, China.
Forests, thickets, moist shady mountain slopes 800–1600 m

Form
Evergreen perennial groundcover. Mat-forming, spreading via rhizomes/stolons. Compact clumps. Notable for large flowers relative to other Asarum. Not culinary ginger

Foliage
Large, glossy, ovate to sagittate (heart-shaped to arrow-shaped) leaves, 7–15 × 6–11 cm. Green, occasionally with white blotches or reticulate veins.
Evergreen in mild climates. Aromatic when crushed

Flowers and fruit
Large, campanulate, purple-green to deep maroon/purple flowers with white markings or speckles. Often hidden under foliage.
Spring (April–June). Three-pointed, prominent for the genus

Bark
Not applicable (herbaceous perennial)

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Grow as groundcover in shade. Enrich soil with organic matter. Space for spreading. Cut back untidy foliage in late winter/early spring before flowers.
Suitable for woodland, underplanting, shady beds

HEALTH

Health

Generally disease- and pest-free. Deer-resistant. No serious problems stated when properly sited.
May be sensitive to extreme drought or poor drainage

Symptoms

None stated